SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

25 September 2024 · Shift 1

76 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 24 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Select the term from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the given series. HM71, JP68, LS65, NV62, ?

(A) RX59
(B) QY57
(C) PY59
(D) QX58

Q.2

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (24, 15, 120) (21, 19, 133) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (31, 9, 96)
(B) (18, 16, 99)
(C) (27, 12, 108)
(D) (33, 10, 170)

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. CRW: TIN :: DOZ: UFQ :: ALW:?

(A) RCN
(B) RCM
(C) JCN
(D) JCM

Q.7

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different. Note : The odd one out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter cluster.

(A) SQPN
(B) YWVT
(C) NLKI
(D) WVTS

Q.8

In a certain code language, ‘EAGLE’ is written as ‘DZFKD’ and ‘DREAM’ is written as ‘CQDZL’. How will ‘SINCE’ be written in that language?

(A) THMDF
(B) RHMBD
(C) RJOBD
(D) TJODF

Q.9

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially place from left to right in the blanks below to balance the given equation. 75 _ 3 _ 17 _ 8 = 0

(A) ÷, –, –
(B) ×, +, –
(C) –, –, ×
(D) –, –, +

Q.11

All the six members of a family, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6, live together. 2 is the daughter of 3, but 3 is not the mother of 2. 1 and 3 are a married couple. 5 is the sister of 3. 4 is the daughter of 1. 6 is the brother of 2. Who is the mother of 2?

(A) 2
(B) 1
(C) 4
(D) 5

Q.13

The question contains pairs of words that are related to each other in a certain way. Three of the following four word pairs are alike as these have the same relationship and thus form a group. Which word pair is the one that DOES NOT belong to that group? (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must not be related to each other based on the number of letters / number of consonants/vowels in the word.)

(A) Shoes – feet
(B) Book – pages
(C) Flowers – petals
(D) Spectacles – lens

Q.15

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 35, 46, 68, 101, 145, ?

(A) 212
(B) 200
(C) 214
(D) 210

Q.16

Select the option that represents the letters that when sequentially placed from left to right in the blanks below will complete the letter series. Z _ A _ Z _ _ Z A _ Z _

(A) ZZAZZA
(B) AZAZAZ
(C) ZZZAAA
(D) AZZAZZ

Q.17

The position of how many letters will change if each of the letters in the word ‘CORNFLAKES’ is re-arranged in the English alphabetical order from left to right?

(A) Eight
(B) Seven
(C) Nine
(D) Ten

Q.19

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some vegetables are fruits. Some fruits are flowers. All flowers are garlands. Conclusions: I. Some garlands are fruits. II. Some vegetables are flowers. III. Some vegetables are garlands.

(A) Only conclusions I and III follow
(B) Only conclusions II and III follow
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'EXCESS' is written as '726572121', 'ENERGY' is written as '716720927', how will 'ESCAPE' be written in that language?

(A) 72153187
(B) 72153165
(C) 72151167
(D) 71933187

Q.21

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? CQJG, ERMJ, ?, ITSP, KUVS

(A) GSQM
(B) GRPM
(C) GTPM
(D) GSPM

Q.22

Which number will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 27 × 3 + 4 ÷ 2 – 7 = ?

(A) 10
(B) 9
(C) 6
(D) 8

Q.23

11 is related to 121 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 22 is related to 484. To which of the following is 31 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 943
(B) 961
(C) 957
(D) 973

Q.24

The same operation(s) are followed in all the given number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 22 : 45
(B) 7 : 15
(C) 11 : 121
(D) 5 : 11

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 4 : 68 :: 8 : 136 :: 9 : ? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 147
(B) 149
(C) 153
(D) 152

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.2

The record obtained by the measurement of earthquake is called a:

(A) seismic wave
(B) seismograph
(C) seismology
(D) seismogram

Q.3

Ghiyas ud-din Balban had set up a _____ department called 'Diwan-i-arz'.

(A) agriculture
(B) education
(C) commerce
(D) military

Q.4

In chess which of the following may move only diagonally?

(A) The Queen
(B) The Knight
(C) The Rook
(D) The Bishop

Q.5

Which of the following is associated with the retreating monsoon in India?

(A) Loo
(B) Mahawat
(C) October heat
(D) Kaal Baisakhi

Q.6

Which famous santoor player was honoured with the Ustad Hafiz Ali Khan Award in 1998?

(A) Tarun Bhattacharya
(B) Abhay Sopori
(C) Satish Vyas
(D) Shivkumar Sharma

Q.7

The Atal Innovation Mission was launched in year _____.

(A) 2014
(B) 2016
(C) 2021
(D) 2004

Q.8

In 2022, Vinay Mohan Kwatra took charge as the Foreign Secretary of India. Prior to this, he served as the ambassador to which of the following countries?

(A) Nepal
(B) Maldives
(C) Bhutan
(D) Sri Lanka

Q.9

Alla Rakha is famous for playing which of the following musical instruments?

(A) Shehnai
(B) Bansuri
(C) Tabla
(D) Damaru

Q.10
Who suggested the law that the British Government passed in 1856 to support widow remarriage?

(A) Keshub Chandra Sen
(B) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(C) Atmaram Pandurang
(D) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Q.11
Ishwari Prasad is credited to have introduced the _____ Gharana of Kathak.

(A) Raigarh
(B) Jaipur
(C) Banaras
(D) Lucknow

Q.12
Pulakeshin II assumed the title of 'Dakshinapatheshvara' (lord of the south) after defeating which of the following rulers of north India?

(A) Harshavardhana
(B) Rudrasena II
(C) Dhruvasena II
(D) Prabhakarvardhana

Q.13
Makar Sankranti is the festival dedicated to which of the following Lords?

(A) Indra
(B) Surya
(C) Chandra
(D) Ganesha

Q.14
When did a States Reorganisation Commission was set up, which recommended the creation of linguistic States on the basis of larger linguistic groups?

(A) December 1953
(B) December 1963
(C) December 1958
(D) December 1956

Q.15
According to Census of India 2011, female adolescents in the age group of 10-19 years had a share of:

(A) 52.7%
(B) 20.9%
(C) 47.3%
(D) 31.3%

Q.16
Which part of the Indian Constitution deals with the Election Commission?

(A) Part XII
(B) Part XV
(C) Part IV
(D) Part XI

Q.17
Which of the following is an example of an eastern coast port?

(A) Mumbai Port
(B) Mormugao Port
(C) New Mangalore Port
(D) Chennai Port

Q.18
In 1910, The United India House at Seattle, USA, was set up by _____.

(A) Tarak Nath Das and GD Kumar
(B) Shyamji Krishna Varma
(C) VD Savarkar and Ganesh
(D) Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki

Q.19
An organic reaction used to convert an aryl diazonium salt into an aryl halide using a copper(I) halide catalyst is called:

(A) Sandmeyer reaction
(B) Balz-Schiemann reaction
(C) Finkelstein reaction
(D) Gattermann reaction

Q.20
Which Article of the Indian Constitution provides for protecting and improving the environment and safeguarding forests and wildlife?

(A) Article 48-A
(B) Article 47-A
(C) Article 47-B
(D) Article 49-C

Q.21
NDP = _____.

(A) GDP + Net factor income from abroad
(B) GDP – Net factor income from abroad
(C) GDP – Depreciation
(D) GDP + Depreciation

Q.22
What is the primary objective of the Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises Development (MSMED) Act of 2006 in India?

(A) To increase import tariffs to protect MSMEs
(B) To focus on large-scale industries only
(C) To regulate foreign companies
(D) To promote and facilitate the development of MSMEs

Q.23
Where was the Durand Cup Tournament started in India in 1888?

(A) Shimla
(B) Mumbai
(C) Calcutta
(D) Delhi

Q.24
Which essential amino acid enhances calcium absorption and also plays an important role in the formation of collagen?

(A) Tyrosine
(B) Histidine
(C) Lysine
(D) Arginine

Q.25
According to Mendeleev's Periodic Table, which elements' properties matched up remarkably well with eka-silicon?

(A) Scandium
(B) Gallium
(C) Titanium
(D) Germanium

Quantitative Aptitude 9 questions

Q.2
The salaries of P and Q together amount to ₹9,60,000. P and Q save 64% and 44%, respectively of their individual salaries. If P's expenditure is 1.5 times Q's expenditure, then what is the ratio of P's salary to Q's salary?

(A) 2 : 3
(B) 3 : 2
(C) 3 : 7
(D) 7 : 3

Q.10
The side BC of ΔABC is produced to a point D. If AC = BC and ∠BAC = 70°, then find the value of ∠ACD – ∠ABC.

(A) 60°
(B) 70°
(C) 45°
(D) 75°

Q.11

Rohini buys a Bluetooth headphone set for ₹1,700 from a wholesale shop and marks it at ₹2,000. Later on, she allows a discount of 40% on its sale. What is her loss or gain percentage (correct up to two decimal places)?

(A) 29.41% gain
(B) 25.19% loss
(C) 25.19% gain
(D) 29.41% loss

Q.12

It is always possible to draw a circle passing through _____ non-collinear points in a plane.

(A) 3
(B) 6
(C) 5
(D) 4

Q.13

The simple interest on a sum for 6 years is three-fifth of the sum. The rate of interest per annum is:

(A) 3%
(B) 7%
(C) 10%
(D) 5%

Q.14

The average of the squares of the first 48 natural numbers is

(A) 792.17
(B) 793.17
(C) 794.17
(D) 791.17

Q.15

Nihira is 25 years old and Punith is 30 years old. How many years ago was the ratio of their ages 3 : 4?

(A) 10 years
(B) 15 years
(C) 5 years
(D) 20 years

Q.20

Suppose P starts walking at a speed of 8 km/h. After 8 hours B started travelling on a bicycle at a speed of 24 km/h. The distance from the starting B can catch A is:

(A) 88 km
(B) 96 km
(C) 72 km
(D) 64 km

Q.23

If the lengths of two sides of an isosceles triangle are 6 cm and 12 cm, then find the length of the third side.

(A) 8 cm
(B) 12 cm
(C) 14 cm
(D) 6 cm

English Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. P) achieve success Q) when you R) and polite S) stay humble

(A) RQPS
(B) PQRS
(C) PRQS
(D) SRQP

Q.2

Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Leela was in class when the big fight happened. So, if you want to know the details, You should ask her, you will get the truth “given by somebody who is directly involved and therefore likely to be accurate.”

(A) shooting off the cuff
(B) with kid gloves
(C) calling a spade a spade
(D) straight from the horse’s mouth

Q.3

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. My dog / barks / very louder / at night.

(A) at night
(B) barks
(C) very louder
(D) My dog

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Dissolve

(A) Appear
(B) Fade
(C) Solve
(D) Vanish

Q.5

The following sentence contains a word with a spelling error. Rectify the sentence by selecting the correct spelling of the identified word from the given options. Later on, he was truely apologetic for his misconduct in the meeting.

(A) Truily
(B) Trooly
(C) Truly
(D) Treuly

Q.6

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Exhileration
(B) Exilaration
(C) Exhillaration
(D) Exhilaration

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Laudable

(A) Humorous
(B) Deplorable
(C) Commendable
(D) Severe

Q.8

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. A comic play was performed by the comedian.

(A) The comedian do perform a comic play.
(B) The comedian performance a comic play.
(C) The comedian performed a comic play.
(D) The comedian performs a comic play.

Q.9

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The research team is conducting experiments on a new drug that could revolutionise the treatment of the disease.

(A) Experiments are conducted on a new drug that could revolutionise the treatment of the disease from the research team.
(B) Experiments were being conducted on a new drug that could revolutionise the treatment of the disease by the research team.
(C) Experiments have been conducted on a new drug that could have revolutionised the treatment of the disease through the research team.
(D) Experiments are being conducted on a new drug that could revolutionise the treatment of the disease by the research team.

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word to fill in the blank. Ram “failed” initially but after a few years, he _____ in every field.

(A) enjoyed
(B) elevated
(C) succeeded
(D) reserved

Q.11

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The company specialises at / designing, crafting and manufacturing / exquisite, high-quality furniture / of exceptional craftsmanship.

(A) designing, crafting and manufacturing
(B) The company specialises at
(C) of exceptional craftsmanship
(D) exquisite, high-quality furniture

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Derogatory

(A) Delegation
(B) Insulting
(C) Salutary
(D) Derivative

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Raj is very interested in studying human psychology, so he decided to pursue his master's degree in _____.

(A) Archaeology
(B) Psychology
(C) Philosophy
(D) Anatomy

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined part in the following sentence. The entire speech of the revivalist "fell flat with" the crowd that was present there.

(A) had somewhat of a result on
(B) had a great impact on
(C) had moderate influence on
(D) had no effect on

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A performer's first public appearance

(A) Foundation
(B) Premise
(C) Dawn
(D) Debut

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. To go through an area making a lot of noise and causing damage

(A) Violence
(B) Cacophony
(C) Rampage
(D) Brutality

Q.17

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. (A) and was searching for them (B) the grandmother couldn't find (C) all around the house (D) placed them on her head (E) her spectacles because she had

(A) BADEC
(B) CABED
(C) BEDAC
(D) ADBEC

Q.18

Select the option that can substitute/replace the bracketed word correctly and complete the sentence. If he runs, he (get) there in time.

(A) got there in time
(B) will get
(C) is getting
(D) has to get

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. We went to a “legitimate” Mexican restaurant for my birthday, where they served cuisine like you would find in Mexico.

(A) productive
(B) genuine
(C) fictitious
(D) falsified

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. Our university is “affiliated” with various institutes all over the world.

(A) disparate
(B) unalike
(C) diverse
(D) allied

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Kuno Palpur National Park, located in Madhya Pradesh's Chambal (1)_____, has an area of 750 square kilometres. It now has leopards, jackals, spotted deer, sambhar, neelgai, chinkara, wild boar, and four-horned antelope, making it a perfect (2)_____ base for felids. Despite strong objections from Gujarat, which (3)_____ that lions were part of the state's heritage, that MP had a poor (4)_____ in wildlife management, and that Kuno Palpur had other big cat species that would (5)_____ lion relocation, the sanctuary was chosen for the lion reintroduction project in 2013.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) reason
(B) river
(C) reign
(D) region

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Kuno Palpur National Park, located in Madhya Pradesh's Chambal (1)_____, has an area of 750 square kilometres. It now has leopards, jackals, spotted deer, sambhar, neelgai, chinkara, wild boar, and four-horned antelope, making it a perfect (2)_____ base for felids. Despite strong objections from Gujarat, which (3)_____ that lions were part of the state's heritage, that MP had a poor (4)_____ in wildlife management, and that Kuno Palpur had other big cat species that would (5)_____ lion relocation, the sanctuary was chosen for the lion reintroduction project in 2013.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) aid
(B) fun
(C) guard
(D) prey

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Kuno Palpur National Park, located in Madhya Pradesh's Chambal (1)_____, has an area of 750 square kilometres. It now has leopards, jackals, spotted deer, sambhar, neelgai, chinkara, wild boar, and four-horned antelope, making it a perfect (2)_____ base for felids. Despite strong objections from Gujarat, which (3)_____ that lions were part of the state's heritage, that MP had a poor (4)_____ in wildlife management, and that Kuno Palpur had other big cat species that would (5)_____ lion relocation, the sanctuary was chosen for the lion reintroduction project in 2013.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) restricted
(B) adjourned
(C) accused
(D) claimed

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Kuno Palpur National Park, located in Madhya Pradesh's Chambal (1)_____, has an area of 750 square kilometres. It now has leopards, jackals, spotted deer, sambhar, neelgai, chinkara, wild boar, and four-horned antelope, making it a perfect (2)_____ base for felids. Despite strong objections from Gujarat, which (3)_____ that lions were part of the state's heritage, that MP had a poor (4)_____ in wildlife management, and that Kuno Palpur had other big cat species that would (5)_____ lion relocation, the sanctuary was chosen for the lion reintroduction project in 2013.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) summary
(B) gaze
(C) record
(D) loss

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Kuno Palpur National Park, located in Madhya Pradesh's Chambal (1)_____, has an area of 750 square kilometres. It now has leopards, jackals, spotted deer, sambhar, neelgai, chinkara, wild boar, and four-horned antelope, making it a perfect (2)_____ base for felids. Despite strong objections from Gujarat, which (3)_____ that lions were part of the state's heritage, that MP had a poor (4)_____ in wildlife management, and that Kuno Palpur had other big cat species that would (5)_____ lion relocation, the sanctuary was chosen for the lion reintroduction project in 2013.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) Jeopardise
(B) Innocuous
(C) channelise
(D) safeguard

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**			

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) PY59

First letters move +2 (H, J, L, N, P), second letters +3 (M, P, S, V, Y) and the numbers fall by 3 (71, 68, 65, 62, 59): PY59.

Q.2 · Answer (C) (27, 12, 108)

In each set, first × second ÷ 3 = third: 24 × 15 ÷ 3 = 120 and 21 × 19 ÷ 3 = 133. Likewise 27 × 12 ÷ 3 = 108.

Q.5 · Answer (A) RCN

Each letter moves 9 places back, wrapping round after A: C → T, R → I, W → N and D → U, O → F, Z → Q. So A → R, L → C and W → N: RCN.

Q.7 · Answer (D) WVTS

SQPN, YWVT and NLKI move –2, –1, –2. WVTS moves –1, –2, –1, so it is the odd one.

Q.8 · Answer (B) RHMBD

Each letter moves one place back: EAGLE → DZFKD and DREAM → CQDZL. So SINCE → RHMBD.

Q.9 · Answer (A) ÷, –, –

75 ÷ 3 – 17 – 8 = 25 – 17 – 8 = 0.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 1

3 is a parent of 2 but not the mother, so 3 is 2's father. 1 is married to 3, so 1 is 2's mother.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Shoes – feet

A book is made up of pages, a flower of petals and spectacles of lenses: whole and part. Shoes are worn on the feet; feet are not a part of shoes.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 200

The differences are 11, 22, 33, 44, so the next is 55: 145 + 55 = 200.

Q.16 · Answer (A) ZZAZZA

With Z, Z, A, Z, Z, A in the blanks the block ZZA repeats: ZZA ZZA ZZA ZZA.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Eight

In alphabetical order CORNFLAKES becomes ACEFKLNORS. Only L (sixth) and S (tenth) keep their places, so eight letters change position.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows

Some fruits are flowers and all flowers are garlands, so some fruits are garlands, and some garlands are fruits (I). Nothing links vegetables to flowers or garlands for certain, so II and III do not follow.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 72153187

Each letter is written as its place in the alphabet plus 2: E → 7, X → 26, C → 5, S → 21. So ESCAPE → 7, 21, 5, 3, 18, 7: 72153187.

Q.21 · Answer (D) GSPM

First letters move +2 (C, E, G, I, K), second letters +1 (Q, R, S, T, U), third letters +3 (J, M, P, S, V) and fourth letters +3 (G, J, M, P, S): GSPM.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 8

After interchanging the signs: 27 ÷ 3 – 4 × 2 + 7 = 9 – 8 + 7 = 8.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 961

Each number is related to its square: $11^2 = 121$ and $22^2 = 484$. So $31^2 = 961$.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 11 : 121
In 22 : 45, 7 : 15 and 5 : 11 the second number is twice the first plus 1. 11 : 121 is a square (11^2), so it is the odd one.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 153
The second number is 17 times the first: 4 × 17 = 68 and 8 × 17 = 136. Likewise 9 × 17 = 153.

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (D) seismogram
A seismogram is the record made by a seismograph, the instrument that measures earthquake waves; seismology is the study of earthquakes.

Q.3 · Answer (D) military
The Diwan-i-Arz was the military department, in charge of recruiting, equipping and paying the army; Balban used it to strengthen his forces.

Q.4 · Answer (D) The Bishop
The bishop moves only diagonally. The queen moves both straight and diagonally, the rook only straight, and the knight in an L shape.

Q.5 · Answer (C) October heat
As the monsoon retreats in October and November, high temperature and humidity make the weather oppressive: the 'October heat'. The loo blows in summer, mahawat is winter rain from western disturbances, and kaal baisakhi is a pre-monsoon storm.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Shivkumar Sharma
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma, the santoor maestro, received the Ustad Hafiz Ali Khan Award in 1998.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 2016
NITI Aayog set up the Atal Innovation Mission in 2016 to promote innovation and entrepreneurship.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Nepal
Vinay Mohan Kwatra was India's ambassador to Nepal before he became Foreign Secretary in May 2022.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Tabla
Ustad Alla Rakha was a celebrated tabla player, and the father of Zakir Hussain.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar's campaign and petitions led to the Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act of 1856.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Lucknow
Ishwari Prasad is regarded as the founder of the Lucknow gharana of Kathak.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Harshavardhana
Pulakeshin II, the Chalukya king of Badami, defeated Harshavardhana on the banks of the Narmada and stopped his advance into the Deccan.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Surya
Makar Sankranti marks the sun's entry into Makara (Capricorn) and is dedicated to Surya, the sun god.

Q.14 · Answer (A) December 1953
The States Reorganisation Commission under Fazl Ali was set up in December 1953; its report led to the States Reorganisation Act of 1956.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 47.3%
SSC's key gives 47.3%: the share of girls among India's adolescents (aged 10-19) in the 2011 census, against 52.7% boys.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Part XV
Part XV (Articles 324 to 329) deals with elections; Article 324 vests their superintendence in the Election Commission.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Chennai Port
Chennai is on the east coast, on the Bay of Bengal; Mumbai, Mormugao and New Mangalore are west-coast ports.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Tarak Nath Das and GD Kumar
Tarak Nath Das and G.D. Kumar set up the United India House at Seattle in 1910.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Sandmeyer reaction
In the Sandmeyer reaction a copper(I) halide replaces the diazonium group of an aryl diazonium salt with a halogen. The Gattermann reaction uses copper powder and a halogen acid instead.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Article 48-A
Article 48A, a Directive Principle added by the 42nd Amendment in 1976, asks the State to protect and improve the environment and safeguard forests and wildlife.

Q.21 · Answer (C) GDP – Depreciation
Net domestic product is gross domestic product less depreciation (the consumption of fixed capital). Adding net factor income from abroad to GDP gives GNP.

Q.22 · Answer (D) To promote and facilitate the development of MSMEs
The MSMED Act, 2006 provides for facilitating the promotion and development of micro, small and medium enterprises and enhancing their competitiveness.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Shimla
SSC's key gives Shimla, where the Durand Cup, Asia's oldest football tournament, was started in 1888; it is named after Sir Mortimer Durand, then India's Foreign Secretary.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Lysine
Lysine, an essential amino acid, helps the body absorb calcium and is needed for the formation of collagen.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Germanium
Mendeleev left a gap for eka-silicon and predicted its properties; germanium, discovered in 1886, matched them closely.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.2 · Answer (D) 7 : 3
P spends 36% of his salary and Q 56%. $0.36P = 1.5 \times 0.56Q = 0.84Q$, so $P : Q = 0.84 : 0.36 = 7 : 3$.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 70°
AC = BC, so the angles opposite them are equal: $\angle ABC = \angle BAC = 70°$ and $\angle ACB = 40°$. $\angle ACD = 180° - 40° = 140°$, so $\angle ACD - \angle ABC = 70°$.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 29.41% loss
SP = 60% of ₹2,000 = ₹1,200, a loss of ₹500 on ₹1,700: $500/1{,}700 \times 100 = 29.41\%$.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 3
Any three non-collinear points lie on exactly one circle: the circumcircle of the triangle they form.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 10%
$SI = 3P/5 = P \times R \times 6/100$, so $R = 60/6 = 10\%$.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 792.17
The sum of the squares of 1 to n is $n(n + 1)(2n + 1)/6$, so their average is $(n + 1)(2n + 1)/6 = 49 \times 97/6 = 792.17$.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 10 years
$(25 - x)/(30 - x) = 3/4$ gives $100 - 4x = 90 - 3x$, so $x = 10$.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 96 km

In 8 hours the walker covers 8 × 8 = 64 km. B gains 24 − 8 = 16 km/h, so he catches up in 64/16 = 4 hours, having ridden 24 × 4 = 96 km.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 12 cm

The third side equals one of the other two. If it were 6 cm, then 6 + 6 = 12 would not exceed the third side and no triangle could form; so it is 12 cm (sides 6, 12 and 12).

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) SRQP

'Stay humble (S) and polite (R) when you (Q) achieve success (P).'

Q.2 · Answer (D) straight from the horse's mouth

To hear something 'straight from the horse's mouth' is to hear it from the person directly involved.

Q.3 · Answer (C) very louder

'Barks' needs an adverb, not a comparative adjective: 'barks very loudly'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Appear

To 'dissolve' can mean to fade away or disappear; its opposite is 'appear'. 'Fade' and 'vanish' are close in meaning to it.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Truly

The correct spelling is 'truly': the 'e' of 'true' is dropped.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Exhilaration

The correct spelling is 'exhilaration'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Deplorable

'Laudable' means deserving praise; its opposite is 'deplorable'. 'Commendable' is a synonym.

Q.8 · Answer (C) The comedian performed a comic play.

The past passive 'was performed by' becomes the simple past active: 'The comedian performed a comic play.'

Q.9 · Answer (D) Experiments are being conducted on a new drug that could revolutionise the treatment of the disease by the research team.

The present continuous 'is conducting' becomes 'are being conducted', with the agent at the end: 'by the research team'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) succeeded

The opposite of 'failed' is 'succeeded'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) The company specialises at

'Specialise' takes the preposition 'in', not 'at': 'The company specialises in designing'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Insulting

'Derogatory' means showing a low opinion of someone: 'insulting'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Psychology

The study of the human mind and behaviour is 'psychology'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) had no effect on

A speech that 'falls flat with' an audience fails to have any effect on it.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Debut

A 'debut' is a performer's first public appearance.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Rampage

To 'rampage' is to rush about noisily and violently, causing damage.

Q.17 · Answer (C) BEDAC
'The grandmother couldn't find (B) her spectacles because she had (E) placed them on her head (D) and was searching for them (A) all around the house (C).'

Q.18 · Answer (B) will get
A first conditional: 'if' with the present ('runs') in one clause and 'will' with the verb in the other: 'he will get there in time'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) genuine
'Legitimate' here means real or authentic: 'genuine'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) allied
'Affiliated' means officially connected: 'allied'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) region
The park lies in the Chambal 'region' of Madhya Pradesh.

Q.22 · Answer (D) prey
The animals listed are what big cats hunt: a 'prey base' for felids.

Q.23 · Answer (D) claimed
Gujarat 'claimed' that lions were part of its heritage, one of its objections to the move.

Q.24 · Answer (C) record
A poor 'record' in wildlife management: a poor past performance.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Jeopardise
Other big cats that would 'jeopardise' (endanger) the lions' relocation; 'safeguard' says the opposite.

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